

AJAY KUMAR M

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Objective

Results-driven Lead Engineer with extensive experience in API development, system architecture, and cloud-native solutions. Proven expertise in designing scalable, high-performance distributed systems and leading engineering teams to deliver robust, secure, and maintainable applications. Passionate about leveraging modern technologies and best practices in microservices, event-driven architectures, and DevOps to drive innovation and operational excellence.

Experience

Lead Engineer: Air India, India

02/2025 - Present

- Leading the design and development of multiple critical APIs and distributed systems, including OCN Event Handling, Passenger Management APIs, and Payment Event Processing solutions.
- Architecting scalable, event-driven backend systems using modern technologies to handle high-volume transactional workflows with strong emphasis on performance, reliability, and fault tolerance.
- Spearheading research and development of Agentic AI systems to automate workflows and introduce intelligent decision-making capabilities across internal platforms.
- Collaborating with cross-functional teams to define system architecture, conduct technical reviews, and ensure seamless integration of new APIs with existing aviation systems.
- Mentoring and guiding a team of junior and mid-level developers on best practices in API design, system architecture, clean code, and DevOps methodologies.
- Driving observability, monitoring, and optimization initiatives to maintain high availability and operational excellence in a regulated aviation environment.

Senior Software Engineer: Phases India Technology Solutions Pvt Ltd, India

06/2019 – 12/2024

- Led a team of 5 developers to design, develop, and deploy enterprise-grade applications using Node.js, TypeScript, and MongoDB.
- Refactored and optimized legacy systems, achieving a 60% improvement in response time using worker threads and load balancing strategies.
- Built a distributed, event-driven architecture leveraging RabbitMQ and Kafka to support high-volume transactional workflows.
- Implemented infrastructure-as-code using Terraform and automated deployments on AWS, cutting provisioning time by over 60%.
- Integrated CI/CD pipelines with GitLab, Docker, and Kubernetes to ensure robust and seamless application delivery.
- Designed and deployed centralized logging and monitoring with the ELK Stack, reducing average issue resolution time by 50%.
- Acted as a liaison between technical and non-technical stakeholders to align project goals and deliverables.

Junior Software Engineer: Unieke Software Solutions, Kochi, India

01/2018 – 05/2019

- Worked as a full-stack developer on consumer-facing web applications using Laravel, Vue.js, Bootstrap, and jQuery.
- Developed a scalable matrimonial platform with real-time chat, profile filtering, role-based access control, and admin dashboards.
- Integrated Progressive Web App (PWA) features and OAuth 2.0 authentication to enhance user accessibility and security.
- Built notification modules for user activity, messaging, and admin alerts to improve engagement and platform interactivity.
- Automated code quality enforcement using PHP CS Fixer and participated in peer code reviews to maintain team standards.

Projects

Podio Backup Tool

2024

- Designed and developed a cloud-based ETL platform to automate backups and data integrations from Podio.
- Utilized Node.js worker threads and BullMQ (Redis) to handle concurrent task execution at scale.
- Deployed using Kubernetes microservices on AWS (Lambda, S3, RDS), supporting real-time space monitoring and alerting.
- Built internal dashboards to track user usage, process logs, and send operational notifications.
- **Tech Stack:** Node.js, TypeScript, BullMQ, Redis, AWS, Docker, MongoDB, MySQL, GitLab

API Integrations

2019 - 2024

- Implemented secure and scalable B2B API integrations with QuickBooks, SAP Concur, Azure AD, and HubSpot.
- Built a PHP SDK for SAP Concur (PSR-7 compliant) to streamline integration for multiple clients.
- Set up Looker Studio on GCP and configured a pipeline to transfer CRM data from HubSpot to BigQuery for analytics.
- Collaborated with .NET and backend teams to build REST APIs for systems with limited legacy support (e.g., MS NAV).
- **Tech Stack:** PHP, REST APIs, HubSpot API, BigQuery, GCP, OAuth 2.0, Azure AD

CVE Alert System (Phases AI Hackathon – 2nd Place)

2024

- Built a real-time vulnerability alert platform during a 24-hour solo hackathon.
- Integrated CVE feeds to monitor and notify users of security issues affecting registered domains and technologies.
- Developed a chatbot to send custom alerts and generate reports for high-risk vulnerabilities.
- **Tech Stack:** Azure BotBuilder, TypeScript, Express.js, MongoDB, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, jQuery

Awards

- **2nd Place – Phases AI Hackathon 2024**

Designed and built a real-time CVE Alert System as a solo developer within 24 hours. The tool tracked Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures (CVEs) and delivered instant alerts via a chatbot and custom dashboard.

Education

BSc Computer Science

05/2014 - 03/2017

Kerala University

Skills

- **Languages:** JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, PHP
- **Backend:** Node.js, Express.js, NestJS, Django, Flask
- **Frontend:** React.js, Vue.js, jQuery
- **API & System Design:** RESTful APIs, GraphQL, API Gateways, Microservices Architecture, Domain-Driven Design (DDD), Event-Driven Architecture
- **DevOps & Infrastructure:** AWS (Lambda, S3, RDS, CloudWatch, SNS, SQS, API Gateway), GCP (BigQuery, Looker Studio), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD
- **Message Queues & Streaming:** Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis, BullMQ, Azure Event Hub
- **Monitoring & Logging:** Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack
- **Databases:** MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB
- **Others:** Git, OAuth 2.0, JWT, WebSockets, gRPC, CI/CD, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), Agile/Scrum